

Billing, Invoicing & Payments

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1. Invoice Charges Explained

All charges are itemized on the invoice under Settings > Billing > Invoice History.

Common line items

- Subscription Fee -- the monthly or annual base plan cost
- Seat Charges -- per-user fees for active seats on the account
- NextIQ AI Assistance -- usage-based charge for AI-assisted sessions at \$0.20 per session
- NextIQ AI Assistance - Overage -- sessions beyond the free allocation included in the plan, also at \$0.20 each
- Transcription & Summarization (T&S) -- add-on charges at \$10 per block after free units run out
- Pro-Rated Adjustments -- partial-month charges when seats or features are added mid-cycle
- Add-On Features -- optional features purchased outside the base plan

2. Subscription Plans

Launch Plan (\$50/seat/month):

- 20 free NextIQ units per agent per billing cycle
- 50 free T&S units per agent per billing cycle
- Basic analytics, Standard support (4-hour SLA)
- Monthly or Annual billing (20% discount on annual)

Grow Plan (\$75/seat/month):

- 50 free NextIQ units per agent per billing cycle
- 200 free T&S units per agent per billing cycle
- Advanced analytics + custom reports, Priority support (1-hour SLA)
- Monthly or Annual billing (20% discount on annual)

Scale Plan (custom enterprise pricing):

- No free NextIQ units -- \$0.20 per session from first use (volume discounts negotiable)
- T&S included by default at no additional charge
- Full analytics suite + dedicated analyst, Dedicated CSM
- Annual billing with custom terms

3. NextIQ AI Assistance Billing

NextIQ is priced at a flat \$0.20 per session (called a WorkItem) across all plans. A session is created when a customer starts a conversation on any channel (chat, SMS, social, voice) or when an agent makes an outbound call.

How it works

- Each session costs \$0.20, regardless of whether the agent uses Manual or Autopilot mode
- One session = one charge, no matter how many AI suggestions are used within that session
- Billing only happens when NextIQ AI is actually used -- if an agent handles a conversation without using NextIQ, there's no charge
- Manual and Autopilot are different modes, not different price tiers

Free units per agent

- Launch: 20 free sessions per agent per billing cycle
- Grow: 50 free sessions per agent per billing cycle

- Scale: No free sessions -- \$0.20 per session from the first use (volume negotiable)

Free units are per agent, not pooled across the team. Each agent has their own quota. If Agent A uses 65 sessions (50 free + 15 overage = \$3.00) and Agent B uses only 30 (all free = \$0.00), Agent B's unused 20 units do NOT cover Agent A's overage.

Free units do not roll over between billing cycles and are not transferable between agents.

Overage example

Grow plan, 30 agents:

Free allocation: 50 per agent x 30 agents = 1,500 total free sessions

February usage: 4,620 AI-assisted sessions

Overage: 4,620 - 1,500 = 3,120 sessions

Overage charge: 3,120 x \$0.20 = \$624.00

4. Transcription & Summarization (T&S)

T&S is a bundled add-on: one unit = one session where both transcription and AI summary are generated. Same per-agent model as NextIQ.

- Launch: 50 free T&S units per agent per cycle; overage at \$10 per add-on block
- Grow: 200 free T&S units per agent per cycle; overage at \$10 per add-on block
- Scale: T&S included by default -- no limits, no additional charge

5. Usage Dashboard & Alerts

The usage dashboard shows per-agent AI consumption and is available under Admin Console > Billing & Usage.

What the dashboard shows

- NextIQ Usage: per-agent sessions, free units used and remaining, mode breakdown (Manual vs Autopilot), overage count
- T&S Usage: per-agent transcription units used and remaining
- Invoice History: monthly invoices with full line-item breakdown
- Data refreshes daily and can be exported to CSV

Usage alerts

Email alerts can be configured to notify when any agent reaches a specified percentage of their free units (e.g., 80%). This gives advance warning before overage charges begin.

Path: Settings > Billing > Notifications

- Usage threshold alert (e.g., email when any agent hits 80% of free NextIQ units)
- Invoice ready notification
- Payment failure notification
- Trial conversion warning

IMPORTANT

Usage alerts are NOT enabled by default. This is the most common reason customers are surprised by overage charges.

6. Autopilot vs Manual Mode -- Cost Impact

Both modes cost the same per session (\$0.20), but Autopilot drives higher usage because it automatically invokes AI on every conversation.

- Manual mode: agent chooses when to use NextIQ -- lower session count per agent
- Autopilot mode: NextIQ monitors every conversation automatically -- higher session count

Autopilot can be toggled per agent, per inbox (queue), or account-wide under Admin Console > NextIQ Settings > Autopilot Configuration.

Cost optimization: keep Autopilot on for high-volume agents handling routine queries (where AI saves the most time), switch low-volume agents to Manual mode (they still have AI access, just on-demand).

7. Credits & Refunds

First-time overage courtesy credit

- Up to \$200 can be applied as a one-time courtesy credit for first-time overage surprises
- Applied to the next invoice (not refunded to the payment method)
- Best practice: also set up usage alerts so the customer isn't surprised again

Duplicate charges

- Verified by comparing Transaction IDs in Billing > Transaction History
- Refunds up to \$500 can be processed directly
- Processing time: 3-5 business days for cards, 5-7 for bank transfers

Trial auto-conversion

- Some features offer free trials that auto-convert to paid if not cancelled
- If the feature shows no usage during the paid period, a courtesy refund for 1 cycle is typical
- Cancel the add-on immediately to stop future charges

AGENT PROCESS (internal -- not customer-facing)

Credit path: Billing > Apply Credit. Agent authority: up to \$200 (no approval needed). Above \$200: supervisor or billing team approval required.

Refund path: Billing > Transaction History > Select charge > Process Refund.

8. Payment Issues

Accepted methods: Visa, Mastercard, Amex, ACH bank transfer (US only).

If a payment fails, the customer has a 7-day grace period with full service. The system retries automatically at Day 1, 3, and 5. If the card is updated, the retry happens within 1 hour.

- Day 0-7: Grace period -- all services continue normally
- Day 7: Account suspended if payment still outstanding
- Day 7-37: Data retained during suspension
- Update payment: Settings > Billing > Payment Method > Update Card

9. Plan Changes & Pro-Rating

- Upgrades take effect immediately; the price difference for remaining days in the cycle is pro-rated
- Downgrades take effect at the start of the next billing cycle -- no mid-cycle refund
- Annual billing saves ~20% but requires a 12-month commitment; usage-based charges (NextIQ, T&S) are still billed monthly

Pro-rating formula: (Monthly Price / Days in Cycle) x Remaining Days x New Seats

Example: 5 seats added Feb 10 at \$50/seat, 18 days remaining in Feb = \$160.71

10. Quick Reference

- Unknown charge --> Check invoice line items, explain the category with their specific numbers
- NextIQ overage --> Per-agent free units (not pooled); show the math; set up alerts

- Duplicate charge --> Verify Transaction IDs, process refund up to \$500
- Pro-rated charge --> Mid-cycle seat/feature addition; explain the formula with their dates
- Payment failed --> 7-day grace period with full service; guide to update card
- Autopilot cost concern --> Per-agent toggle available; hybrid Manual/Autopilot strategy
- Want usage visibility --> Admin Console > Billing & Usage dashboard
- Request credit --> Up to \$200 courtesy for first-time overage, applied to next invoice